Swadesamitran carried a brief notice while *The Hindu* published a longer obituary.[4] Given that he began practice as a lawyer in 1898—as he stated to the Indian Mercantile Marine Committee—he would have been in his early fifties at the time of his death. Presumably, he had resumed his practice after SSNCo's dissolution, for he was the president of the Bar Association of Tuticorin at the time of his passing away. His political involvement did not end with the Swadeshi movement, for *The Hindu* described him as 'a Congressman of the orthodox type and a sincere follower of Mahatmaji'. During the Non-Cooperation Movement, he had suspended his lucrative practice. At the time of his death, Krishna Aiyangar was engaged in a suit to be preferred by two local vakils against nobody less than the secretary of state for India! Ironically, the 300-word obituary makes no mention at all of SSNCo.

K.R. Venkatarama Aiyar vanishes from the scene, as does his brother, K.R. Guruswami Aiyar, despite having held such positions as member of the legislature. Of the thirty odd directors of SSNCo, I could marshal the biographical details of only a few—P. Pandithurai Thevar, S.V. Nallaperumal Pillai, T.S. Subramania Pillai, and K. Chidambaranatha Mudaliar (see Chapters 3 and 5).

A poignant anecdote has survived about V.A.A. Adinarayana Chettiar, one of the directors. Sometime in the early 1930s, when his relative A.P.C. Veerabahu—who later established a college named after VOC—visited Adinarayana Chettiar's home he heard his daughter cursing him for squandering money on the doomed shipping enterprise. Choicest abuses were hurled at VOC as well. A shocked Veerabahu, who ran into VOC on his way back home, shared this experience with him; a downcast VOC could only mumble that she could not be faulted.[5]

Astonishingly, none of VOC's associates left behind any memoir or autobiography. Nor did their descendants claim credit for their illustrious forebears. The historical record is thus so much poorer. For instance, on the occasion of S.V. Nallaperumal Pillai's fiftieth death anniversary, his granddaughter took out a notice in *The Hindu*. The notice described him as a landlord, banker and *mittadar*, and his listed achievements included